Quadreria
STUDIO

What Is a Tech Pack, and Why Your Manufacturer Needs One

THE DOCUMENT THAT TURNS A DESIGN INTO A PRODUCT

A SHORT GUIDE FOR FOUNDERS GETTING READY TO SAMPLE.

What Is a Tech Pack, and Why Your Manufacturer Needs One

Ask ten new founders what a tech pack is, and most will either say "some technical file the factory needs" or quietly admit they've never heard of one. That's completely fair. Nobody explains it until you need it. But by the time you need it, you've often already paid for a sample that didn't turn out the way you imagined.

Our roots are in sampling departments and export houses, and we've watched the same thing happen again and again. When a manufacturer had a clear tech pack, the sample came close to right the first time. When they didn't, everyone guessed, and guessing is where time and money disappear.

So let's break down what a tech pack actually is, and why it matters more than almost anything else you'll create before production.

01 Think of it as your garment's instruction manual.

A design shows what a garment looks like. A tech pack explains exactly how to make it. It's the one document your pattern master, sampling team and production unit all work from. If something isn't written in it, it's open to interpretation, and every interpretation costs you a little more control over your product.

02 Here's what goes inside one.

A complete tech pack usually includes flat sketches (front and back), a measurement chart with sizes and tolerances, fabric and trim details (buttons, zips, labels, threads), stitching and construction notes, colourways, and the exact placement and size of any print or embroidery. Each page answers a question the manufacturer would otherwise have to ask you, or would answer for you.

03 It gets you accurate quotes.

When you send the same tech pack to three manufacturers, you're comparing like with like. Without one, each vendor quotes on their own assumptions about fabric, finishing and detailing, and the cheapest quote often turns out to be the most expensive once the sample arrives.

04 It protects you when things go wrong.

If the bulk order doesn't match the approved sample, the tech pack is your reference point. It shows clearly what was agreed, so the conversation is about fixing the issue, not arguing about who remembered what. It's also what quality checks are measured against.

05 A good tech pack is clear, not complicated.

More pages don't make a tech pack better. Clarity does. Clean sketches, precise measurements, well-labelled callouts, and nothing left to "you know what we mean." The goal is simple: anyone on the factory floor should be able to pick it up and understand the garment without a phone call.

A tech pack isn't paperwork that slows you down. It's what lets you move quickly and with confidence, because everyone is building the same garment you have in your head.

If you'd like to see one in practice, we've put together a free sample tech pack you can download from our website. And if you're preparing your first collection and want production-ready tech packs made for it, that's exactly what we do.

Reach out at: hello@quadreria.studio